

2026 AUSTRALIAN JUNIOR CHESS CHAMPIONSHIP PROBLEM SOLVING U12 CANBERRA

NAME: _____

DATE OF BIRTH: _____

Please circle your age group:

- U8 (born in 2019 or after)
- U10 (born in 2017 or after)
- U12 (born in 2015 or after)

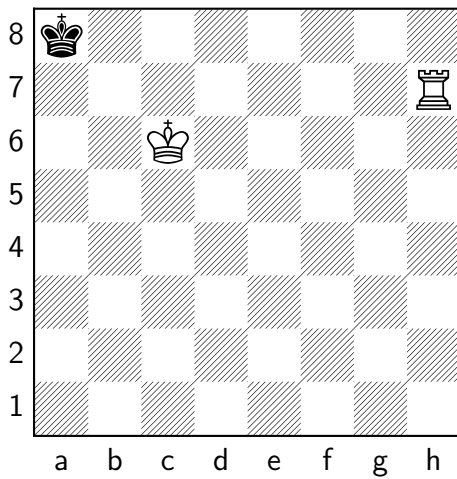
Please circle: Boy or Girl

Please read the following rules.

- You have up to 2 hours for the problem solving paper. You may not need all that time. You may leave after handing in your answers.
- The questions generally go from easy to hard, so it's best to start from the beginning and go in order.
- You can use your chess board and pieces to help you.
- Each page show a question and the marks you can score. Please write your answers in the space under each diagram. Altogether, the test has 100 marks. Even if you don't give perfect answers, you can still get some partial marks.
- For endgame puzzles, show enough moves to reach a position where you are clearly winning or drawing.
- You don't have to finish them all, do your best and solve as many puzzles as you can.

Enjoy the problem solving.

Example Q1. Mate in two.

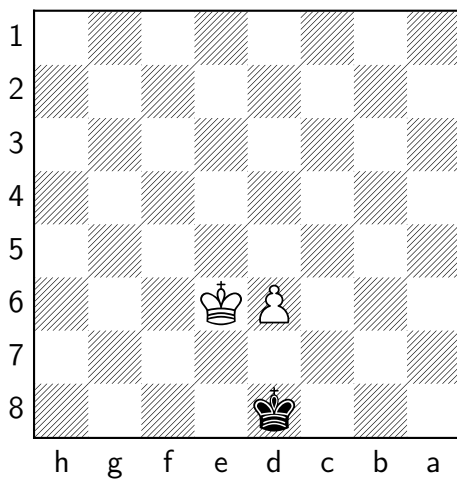


□ The open box shows White's move.

Answer:

1. Kb6 Kb8 ← Write the first White move, then the first Black move.
2. Rh8# (1-0) ← Write the second White move, which is a mate.

Example Q2. Black moves and draws.

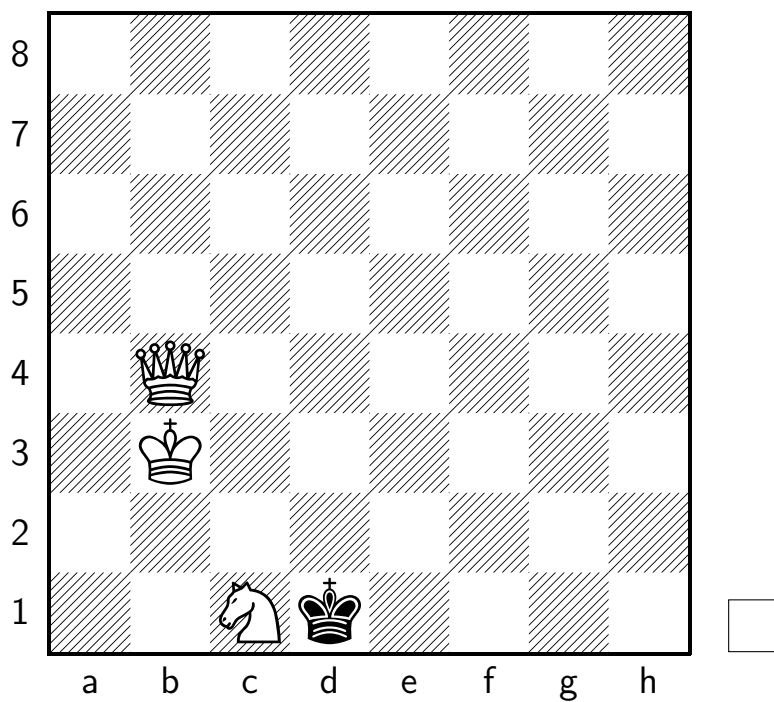


■ The closed box shows Black's move.

Answer:

1. ... Ke8
2. d7+ Kd8
3. Kd6 (draw) ← Write enough moves showing a clear draw position.

Q1. Mate in 2. (4 marks)



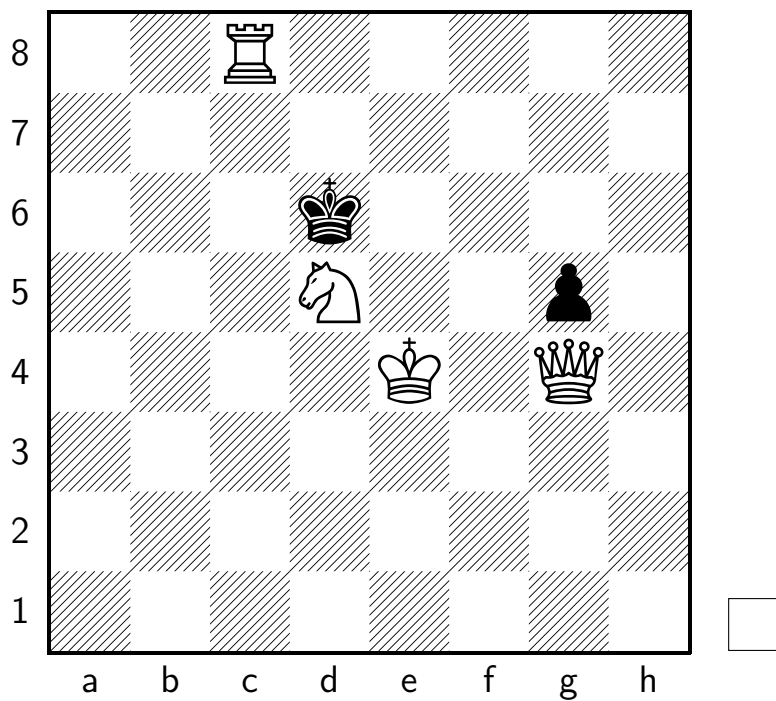
Answer:

1 ♔a5 ♕xc1

2 ♔e1#

Source: 9 Authors Deutsche Schachzeitung, 1968 (YACDB: 82713)

Q2. Mate in 2.



Answer:

1 ♔f5 ♕d7

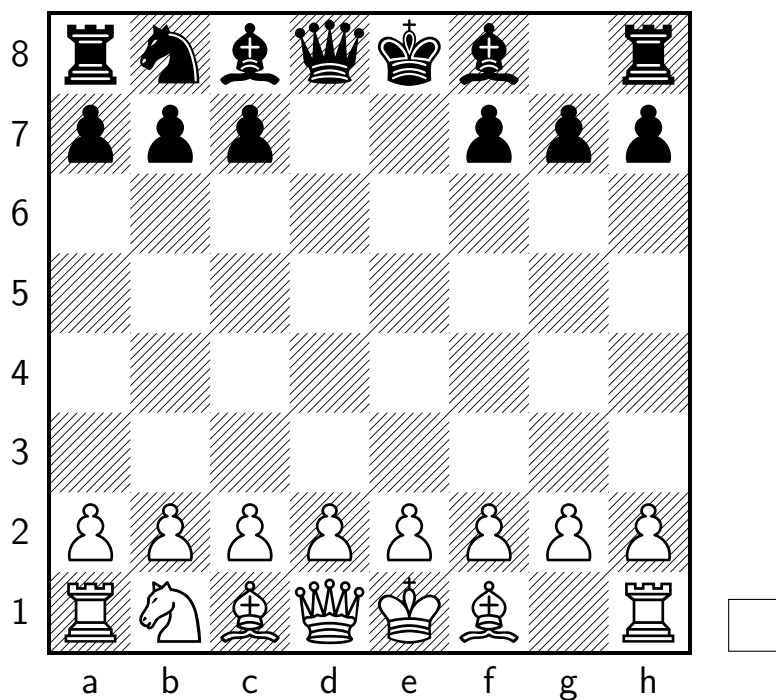
2 ♕e7#

1... ♕x d5

2 ♔d1#

Source: Samuel Loyd, Buffalo Commercial Advertiser, 1879 (YACDB: 32755)

Q3. The position below occurred at the 4th Black's move from the starting position. List the moves that resulted in this position.

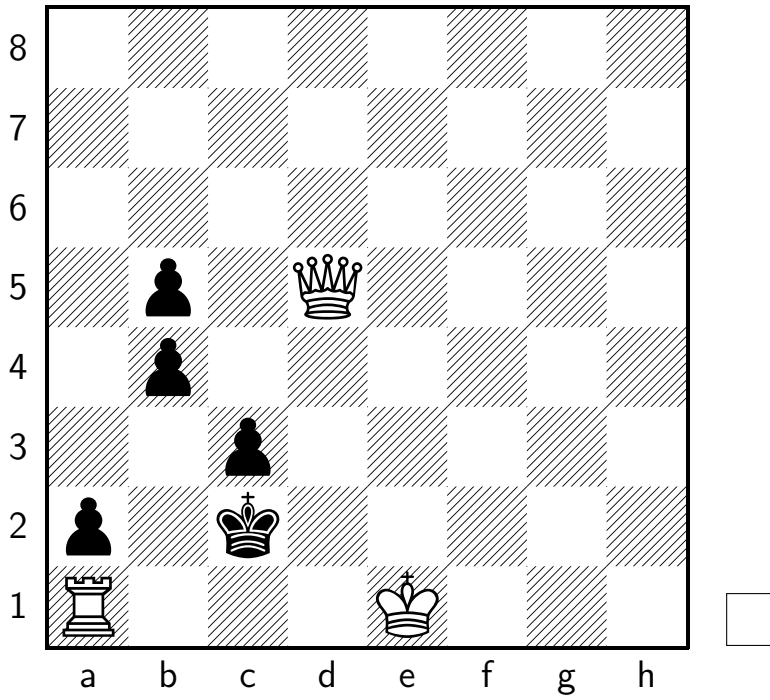


Answer:

- 1 ♖f3 e5
- 2 ♖xe5 ♖e7
- 3 ♖xd7 ♖ec6
- 4 ♖xb8 ♖xb8

Source: Ernest Clement Mortimer (version by Andrey Frolkin) Die Schwalbe, 1981

Q4. Mate in 2.

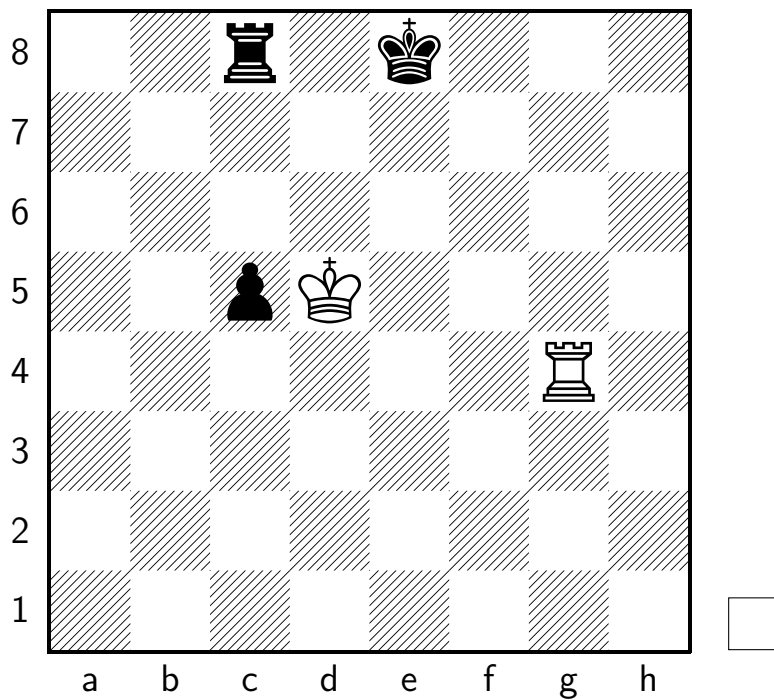


Answer:

1 ♔e6! ♚d3 2 O-O-O#

Source: William Whyatt

Question 5a (Study 1) White to play and win.

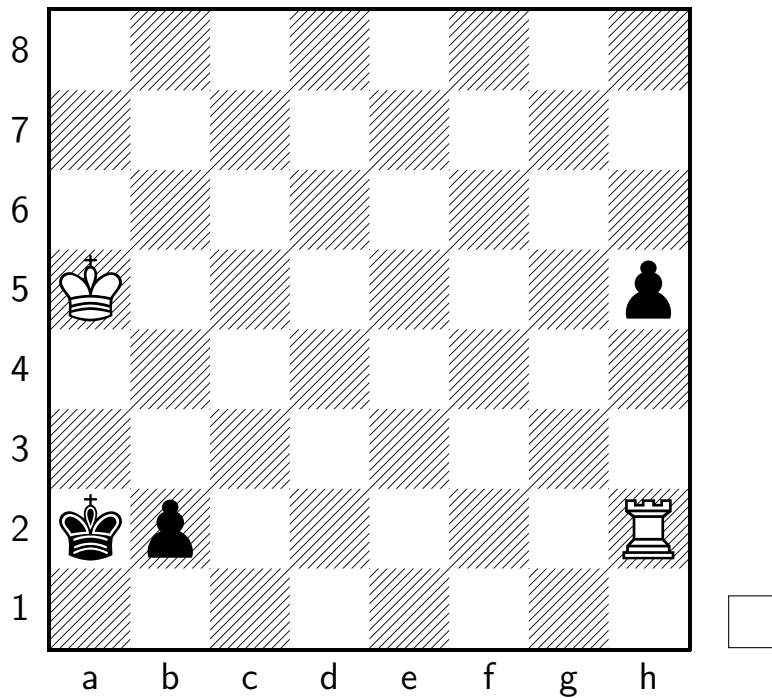


Answer:

- 1 ♖g8+ ♔d7
- 2 ♖g7+ ♔e8
- 3 ♖h7! c4
- 4 ♔d6! ♖d8+
- 5 ♔e6 ♔f8
- 6 ♔h8+ ♔g7
- 7 ♖xd8

Source: Alexey Studenetsky, Shakhmaty v SSSR, 1939

Question 5b (Study 2) White to play and draw.



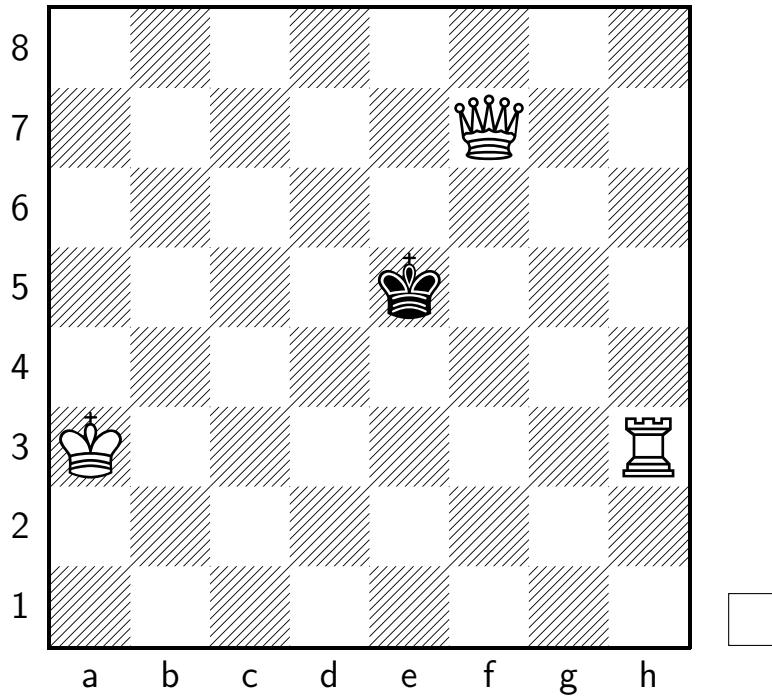
Answer:

1 ♔a6! (Counterintuitive, but the only move.)

1... h4 2 ♔a5 h3 3 ♔a4 ♔a1 4 ♖xh3 b1♔ 5 ♖a3+ ♔a2 6 ♖xa2+ ♔xa2 (draw) (draw)

Source: David Gurgendze, Tiny Endgames, 1999 (YACDB: 276417)

Q6. Mate in 3.



Answer:

1 ♔b4 ♕d6

2 ♖h5 ♔c6

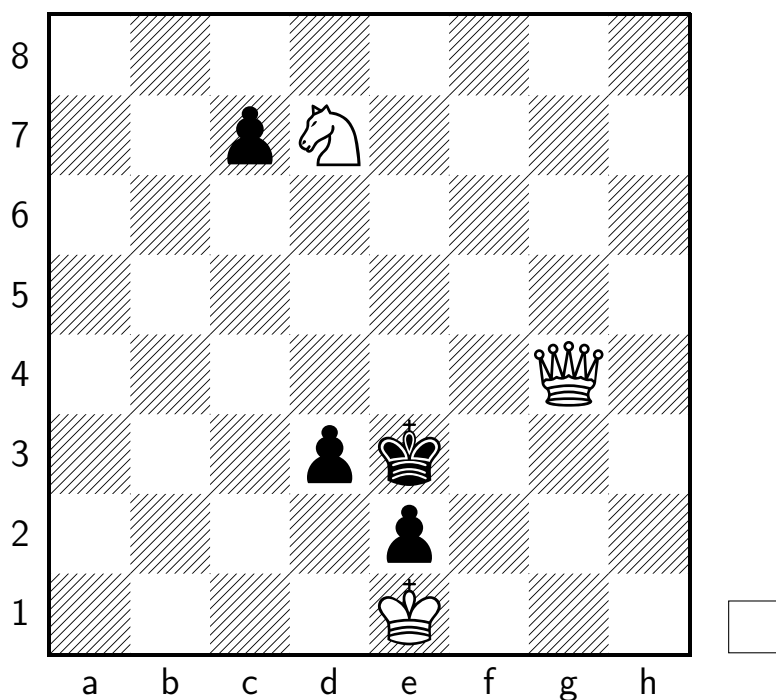
3 ♖h6#

If 1... ♕d4, 2 ♖e8 ♔d5 3 ♖d3#

If 1... ♕e4, 2 ♔c5 ♕e5 3 ♖e3#

Source: Frederick Baird, 1905 (YACDB: 105882)

Q7. Selfmate in 2. White forces Black to mate the White King with Black's 2nd move.



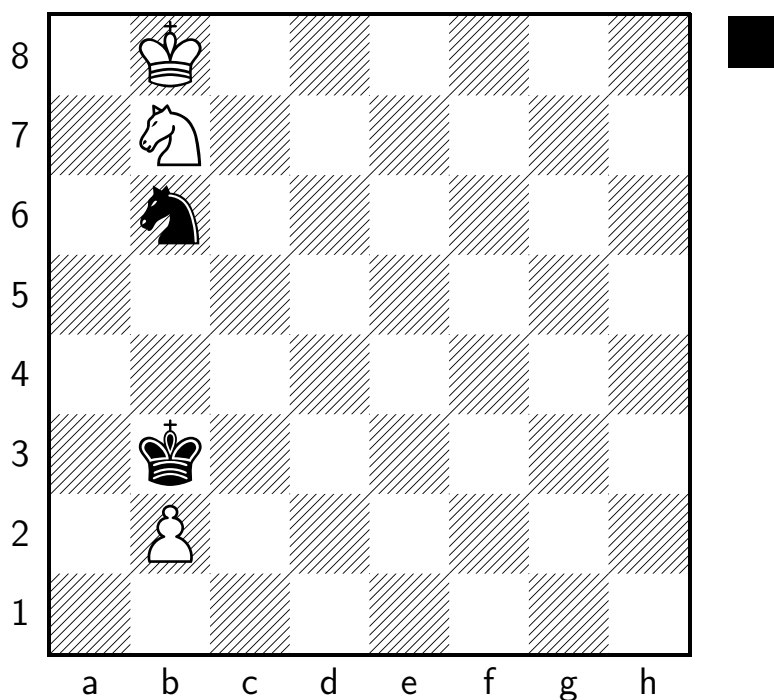
Answer:

1 ♖e5 c5

2 ♚c4 d2#

Source: Alexander Hildebrand, Springaren, 1998 (YACDB: 90375)

Q8. Helpmate in 3. Black to moves first and helps White checkmate in 3 moves.



Answer:

0... ♖d5

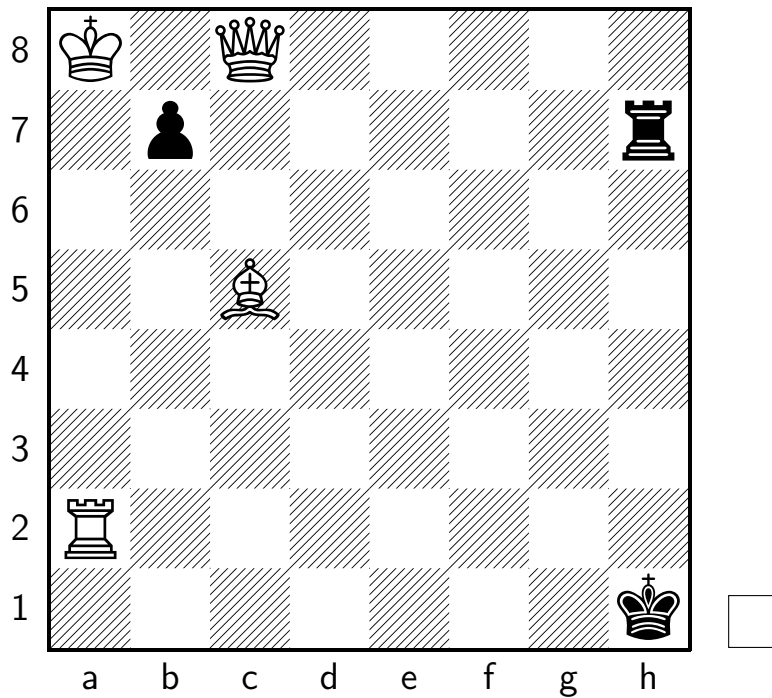
1 ♔a7 ♘b4

2 ♔b6 ♔a4

3 ♘c5#

Source: Henrik Eriksson, stella polaris, 1967 (YACDB: 303520)

Q9. Mate in 2.



Answer:

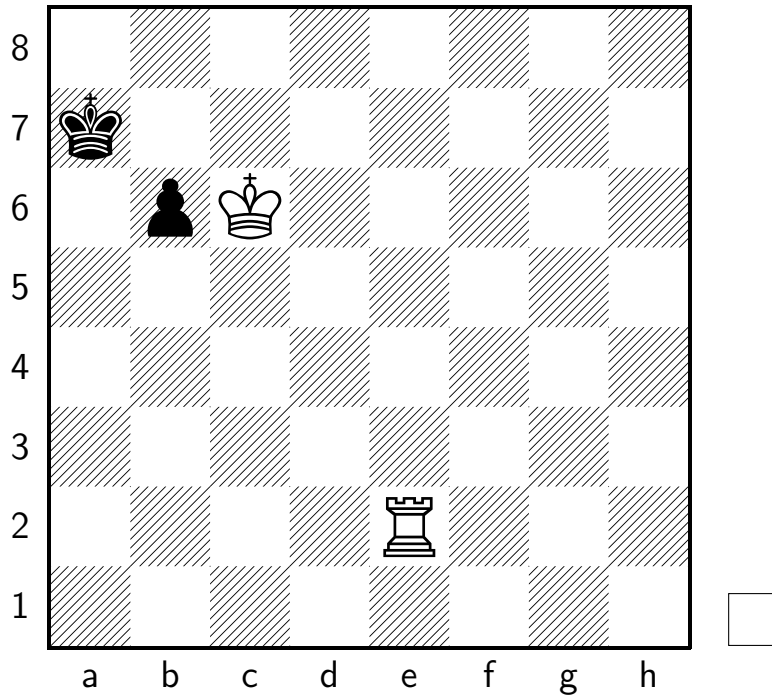
1 ♖d4 creates another threat Qc1 in addition to Qh3 and Qh8.

1... ♜d7 2 ♙c1#

1... ♜c7 2 ♙h3#

Other bishop moves fail, as **1 ♖d4** is necessary to prevent the Black Rook moving to d1.

Q10. Mate in 3.



Answer:

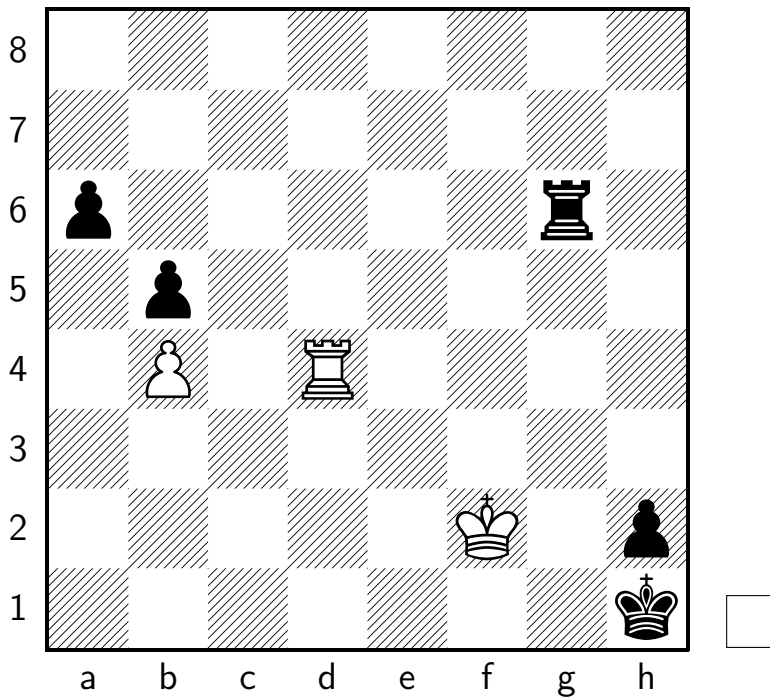
1 ♖c2

1... b5 2 ♔c7 b4 3 ♜a2#

1... ♔a8 2 ♔c7 b5 3 ♜a2#

1... ♔b8 2 ♔xb6 ♔a8 3 ♜c8#

Q11. White to play and win.



Answer:

1 ♖d1+ ♜g1

2 ♜f1! ♜xf1+

3 ♔xf1 a5

4 bxa5 b4

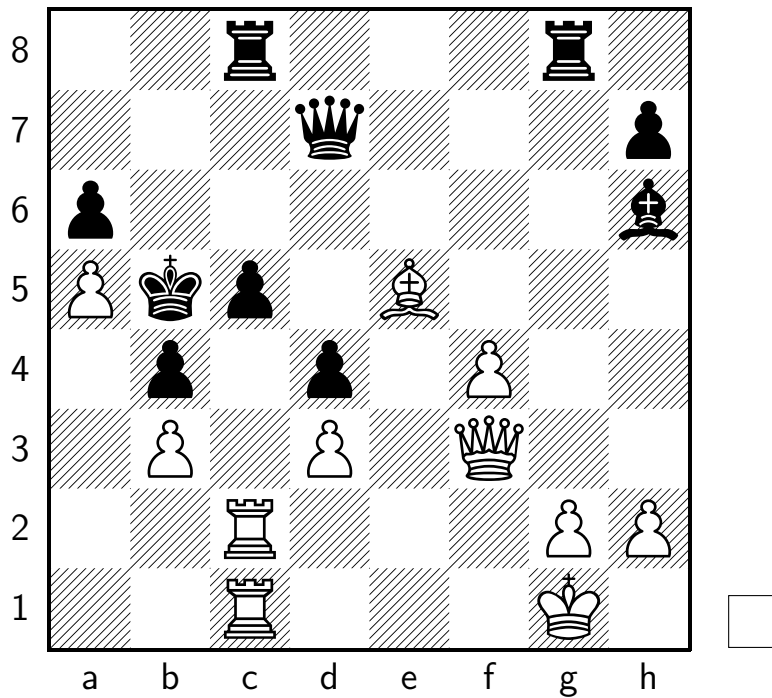
5 a6 b3

6 a7 b2

7 a8♚#

Source: Philippe Stamma, Essai sur le Jeu des Echecs, 1737 (modified)
(YACDB: 394020)

Q12. White to play and win.



Answer:

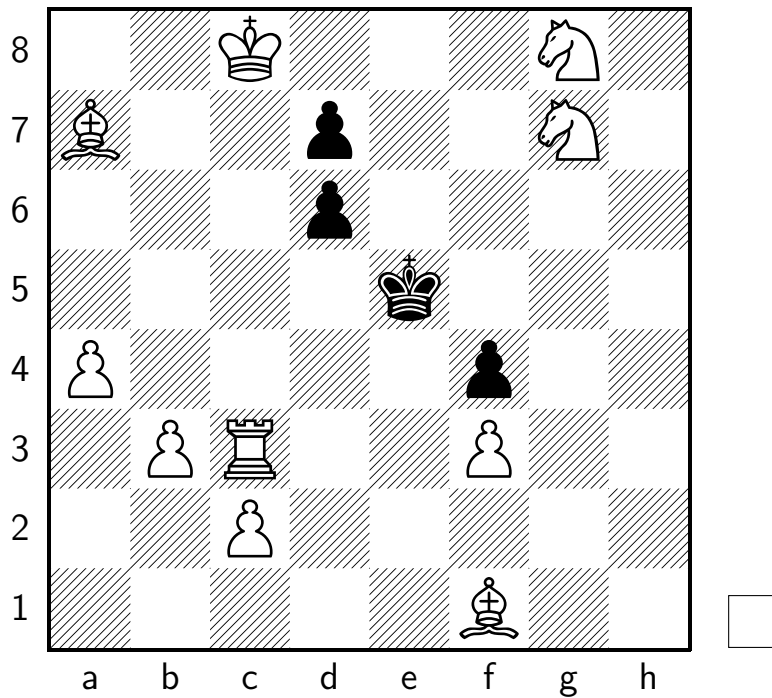
1 ♖c7!

If 1... ♜xc7, 2 ♛b7+! ♜xb7 3 ♜xc5#.

If 1... ♛xc7, 2 ♜xc5+ ♛xc5 3 ♛xb7+ ♛b6 4 ♛xb6#.

Source: Tarrasch - Marotti 1914

Q13. Mate in 3.



Answer:

1 ♖g2! ♔d5 2 ♜e3 fxe3 3 f4#

1 ♖g2! ♔d5 2 ♜e3 ♔c6 3 ♘e7#

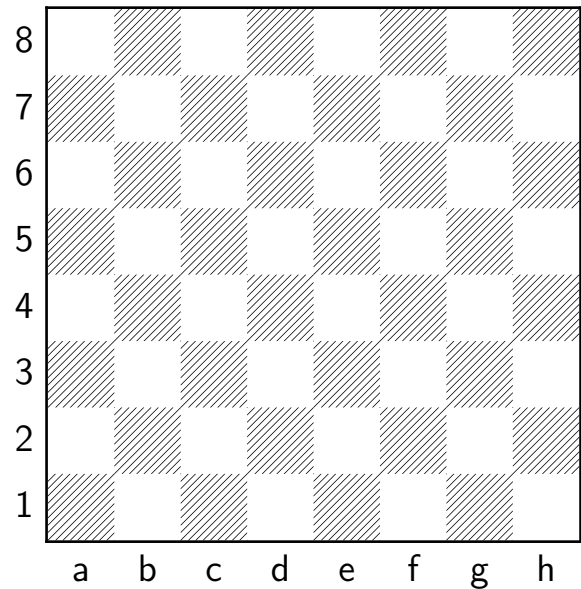
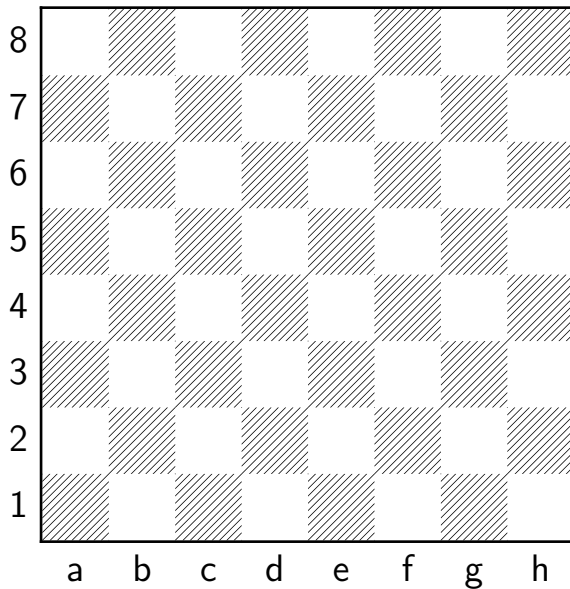
1 ♖g2! d5 2 ♔xd7 d4 3 ♜c5#

1 ♔d7 d5 2 ♜d3+ ♔e5 3 ♔c6 d5 4 ♜d5# (takes 4 moves)

Source: Thomas Denton Clarke, The Brisbane Courier 1918

Q14. 5 Queens Domination puzzle. Place 5 queens on the board so that all the squares are attacked by those 5 queens. (8 marks)

Do you know? There are 7,624,512 (${}_{64}C_5$) patterns to place 5 queens on the board. Among those pattern, 4,860 patterns are correct. In one episode of "Take Take Take" YouTube channel, Magnus Carlsen took about 5 minutes to complete this task. Can you beat him?

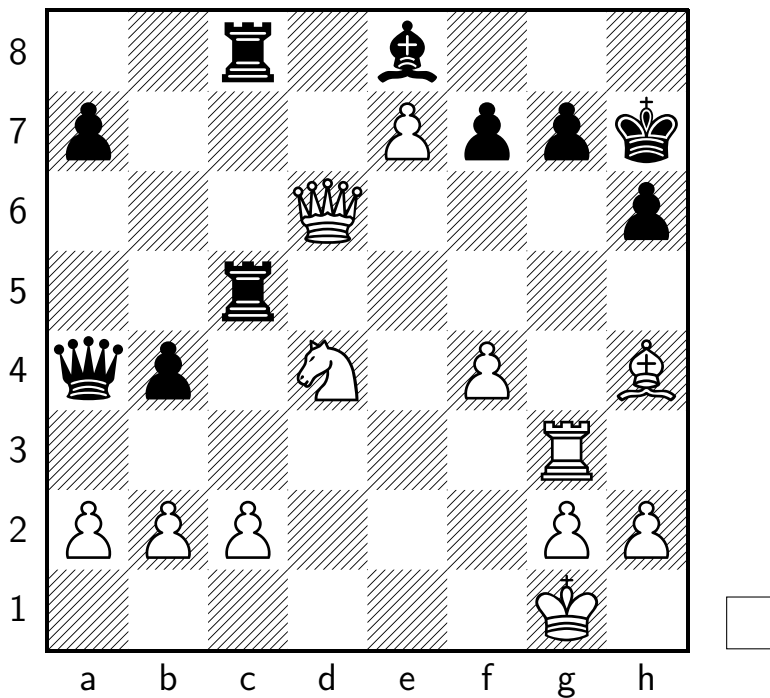


Answer:

Fill 5 squares in the left board with the letters "Q". When you make mistakes in the left board, put a large cross on the left board and use the right board.

Q15. Mate in 8. (8 marks)

In memory of Daniel Naroditsky (1995-2025). He is an American grand master and a famous streamer as "Danya". He tragically passed away in October 2025 at the age of 29.



Answer:

- 1 ♖xg7+!! ♔xg7
- 2 ♕f6+ ♔g8
- 3 ♘e6!! fxe6
- 4 ♕f8+ ♔h7
- 5 ♙f6 ♖g5
- 6 f×g5 ♔g6
- 7 g4 ♕×c3
- 8 ♕g7#

Source: Daniel Naroditsky - Timur Gareyev, U.S. Championship Online Qualifier, 2020